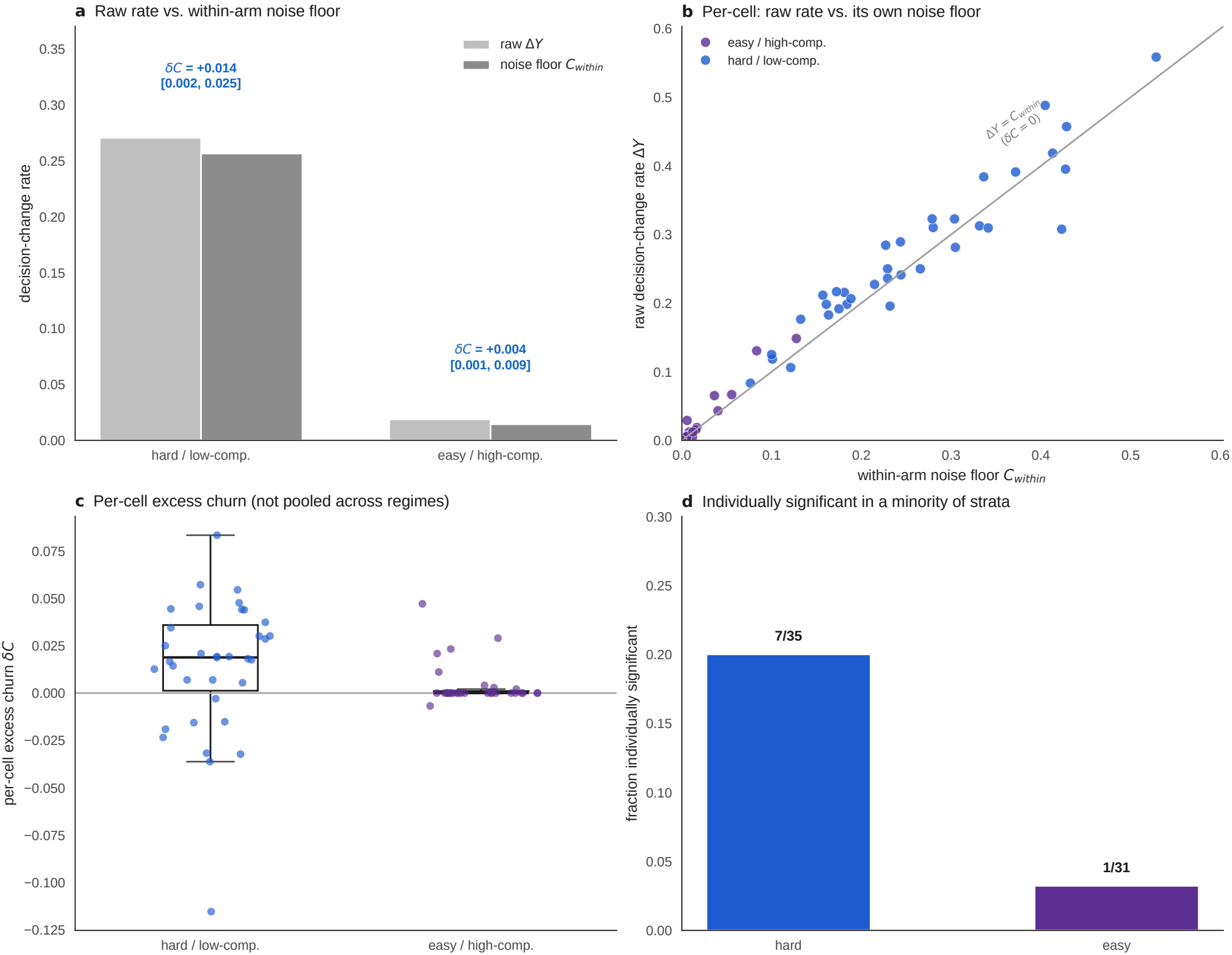The noise canyon